

The Dhāraṇī of Jinottara

Jinottaradhāraṇī · Toh 863 · Derge Kangyur

རྒྱ་བའ་བེ་སྒྲའ་གི་ཟདུས།

This short dhāraṇī text is known in English as The Dhāraṇī of Jinottara, with the Tibetan title rendered as Gyalwé Lama'i Zung, "the dhāraṇī of Jinottara," and a Sanskrit title along the lines of Jinottaradhāraṇī, though the Sanskrit form is not certain from the material at hand. It concerns a protective dhāraṇī-mantra that the bodhisattva Jinottara, a great being, requests permission to present to the Blessed One. The text states that whoever holds and retains it will hold all phenomena, pass beyond the eight unfavorable states, be guarded by yakṣas in every lifetime, and be free from fear of disease. Its brief body consists chiefly of the mantra itself, an invocation of buddhas, awakening, and the blessing of the buddhas. It is Toh 863 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts gathered in the Tantra section.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Jinottara, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, whoever holds this foundation of the dhāraṇī-mantra of Jinottara will hold and retain all phenomena. That person will pass beyond the eight unfavorable states. In all their lifetimes, too, yakṣas will guard, protect, and shelter them, and they will have no fear of any disease."

syād yathedan, buddhe buddhe, jayottara, bodhani bodhani, saṃbodhi
mahāsaṃbodhi, adhivad bhodhani, hala hala hala, hili hili hili, hulu hulu hulu,
sarva buddha, dharmāva bodhini, sphuṭa sphuṭa sphuṭani, sarva pāpāni,
buddha adhiṣṭhānina svāhā.

This completes the dhāraṇī of the noble Jinottara.

Translator's Notes

- The Tibetan rgyal ba'i bla ma is rendered as Jinottara ("Supreme among Victors"). The mantra itself contains "jayottara," so the Sanskrit form could also be Jayottara. The mantra is romanized as it appears in the Tibetan transcription, without emendation. The opening "syād yathedan" probably stands for the usual mantra introduction syādyathedam or tadyathā.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.